FA-004 — Emergency Evacuation, Safety, and Incident Reporting

Document control

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1. Overview

This document covers what employees should do in an emergency, how evacuations are managed, and how safety incidents are reported.

It is written as an FAQ because the questions employees ask are the same questions that come up after every drill and every incident.

2. Evacuation

Q: What do I do when the fire alarm sounds?

A: Stop what you are doing. Leave by the nearest marked exit. Use the stairs, not the elevators. Proceed to the assembly point for your floor — assembly points are posted at every stairwell and near every exit. Wait at the assembly point until you are released by the fire warden or emergency services.

Q: Where are the assembly points?

A: Assembly points are posted at every stairwell and near every exit. For your assigned office, the assembly point is also listed on the intranet page for that office. If you do not know your assembly point, follow the people around you to the nearest exit and proceed to the assembly point indicated there.

Q: Do I need to take my laptop or belongings?

A: No. Leave belongings behind. Take only your phone if it is already in your hand. Evacuation speed matters more than anything you would carry.

Q: How do I know whether it is a drill or a real emergency?

A: You do not, and you should not wait to find out. Treat every alarm as real and evacuate. Drills are announced after the fact, not before.

Q: What if I use a mobility device or need assistance?

A: If you need assistance evacuating, notify your manager and Facilities so a personal evacuation plan can be documented. On the day, proceed to the nearest area of refuge — these are marked at every stairwell — and use the intercom to notify emergency services of your location. A floor warden will come to assist.

Q: What if I am in an elevator when the alarm sounds?

A: Press the button for the nearest floor and exit. Do not attempt to continue to your destination floor.

Q: What if I am the last person leaving my area?

A: Close the door behind you if you can do so safely. Do not attempt to fight fires, contain spills, or retrieve equipment.

3. Shelter-in-place

Q: When is shelter-in-place used?

A: Shelter-in-place is used when evacuation is more dangerous than remaining inside — for example, a severe weather event, an external hazard, or a security incident on the street outside the building.

Q: What do I do?

A: Move away from windows and exterior walls. Follow the instructions of floor wardens and emergency services. Do not leave the building unless instructed.

4. Medical emergency

Q: Someone near me has collapsed. What do I do?

A: Call emergency services first. Then call building security and Facilities. If you are trained in CPR or first aid, provide assistance. If you are not trained, stay with the person until help arrives and send someone else to meet emergency services at the entrance.

Q: Where is the AED?

A: AEDs are located at reception on each floor and near each elevator lobby. Locations are marked on the floor plan posted at each stairwell.

Q: Should I move an injured person?

A: No, unless they are in immediate danger where they are. Moving an injured person can worsen injuries.

5. Safety incident reporting

Q: What counts as a safety incident?

A: Any event that caused or could have caused injury, illness, or property damage. This includes:

- Slips, trips, and falls
- Near-misses where someone almost fell or was almost struck
- Injury from equipment, furniture, or fixtures
- Exposure to hazardous materials
- Security incidents that affected personal safety
- Property damage, even if no one was hurt

Q: How do I report a safety incident?

A: Submit a report through the service portal, selecting Safety Incident as the category. Complete every field, including a description of what happened, where, who was involved, and whether anyone was injured.

Q: How quickly do I need to report?

A: Within 24 hours of the incident, or immediately if there was an injury. Report near-misses too — near-misses are leading indicators of future incidents.

Q: Do I need to report if no one was hurt?

A: Yes. A near-miss is a warning. Reporting near-misses allows Facilities to fix the cause before someone is injured.

Q: Will reporting get me in trouble?

A: No. ABC CORP operates a non-punitive reporting policy. Reporting an incident — including one you caused — will not lead to disciplinary action unless the report reveals willful misconduct or a repeated safety violation after prior coaching.

6. Fire extinguishers and fire safety

Q: Should I use a fire extinguisher?

A: Only if the fire is small, contained, and you have been trained. Otherwise, evacuate and call emergency services. Never place yourself between a fire and your exit.

Q: Can I use a space heater or personal appliance in my workspace?

A: Personal space heaters, hot plates, and appliances with open heating elements are prohibited in ABC CORP offices. Kitchen appliances in designated kitchen areas are permitted.

7. Emergency contacts

Q: Who do I call in an emergency?

A: Emergency services first (911 in the US). Then building security. Building security numbers are posted at reception and near every elevator.

Q: Who do I contact for non-emergency safety concerns?

A: Submit through the service portal as a Safety Concern ticket. Facilities reviews safety concerns weekly.

8. Floor wardens

Q: What is a floor warden?

A: Floor wardens are employees trained to assist with evacuations and emergencies on their floor. They wear identifiable vests during drills and emergencies. Floor wardens are listed on the intranet page for each office.

Q: How do I become a floor warden?

A: Contact Facilities. Wardens complete annual training.

9. Drills

Q: How often are drills?

A: Fire drills are conducted twice per year at each office. Shelter-in-place drills are conducted annually. Drill participation is mandatory for all employees on site.

10. Related documents

- FA-001 Workplace Access Badge and Visitor Management
- FA-003 Maintenance, Cleaning, and Workplace Defect Reporting
- BC-001 Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Helpdesk Playbook
- SE-004 Incident Reporting and Security Escalation

11. Revision history

Version	Date	Change
3.0	04/15/2023	Converted to FAQ format
3.3	03-14-2024	Area of refuge guidance added
3.5	March 14, 2025	Safety incident reporting expanded; non-punitive policy clarified